

» POALES

GIANT FEATHER GRASS*Stipa gigantea*
F: Poaceae

Gardeners cultivate this tall grass for its showy flowerheads, which persist until winter. It is native to Spain, Portugal and Morocco.

2.5 m
8 ftfemale flower
male flowerhead1.5 m
5 ft**BRANCHED BUR-REED***Sparganium erectum*
F: Typhaceae

Separate ball-shaped clusters of male and female flowers develop on the same flower stalk in this widespread wetland species of the northern hemisphere.

3 m
10 ft**CATTAIL***Typha latifolia*
F: Typhaceae

This widespread wetland plant has a distinctive cigar-shaped female flowerhead. The male flowers grow above it in a tuft.

YELLOW-EYED GRASS*Xyris* sp.
F: Xyridaceae

This genus of grasslike plants, widespread in warmer regions of the world, bears small, yellow flowers on slender stems.

30 cm
12 in

ZINGIBERALES

Many species in this mainly tropical order of eight families grow giant leaves at the end of stalks. Although there are no true woody trees, some species such as the banana plant grow very large. Many Zingiberales have showy flowers and foliage and have become ornamentals. The ginger family, Zingiberaceae, the largest in the order, includes several other important spice plants beside ginger itself.

**NEVER-NEVER PLANT***Ctenanthe amabilis*
F: Marantaceae

Native to forest floors in the Brazilian tropics, this warmth-loving plant requires high humidity if grown in cultivation.

40 cm
16 in**ETERNAL FLAME***Goeppertia crocata*
F: Marantaceae

Related to *Ctenanthe* and *Maranta*, this Brazilian species has more striking flowers than its relatives although living in similar forest habitats.

50 cm
20 in**SPIRAL FLAG***Chamaecostus cuspidatus*
F: Costaceae

This orange-flowered plant with dark green, glossy leaves is native to tropical E. Brazil. It is also grown as an ornamental.

60 cm
23½ in**SILVER-VEINED PRAYER PLANT***Maranta leuconeura*
F: Marantaceae

This Brazilian forest plant folds its leaves together at night to conserve moisture. Cultivated varieties have strikingly patterned foliage.

30 cm
12 in**ENSET***Ensete ventricosum*
F: Musaceae

This African-relative of the banana has long been cultivated in Ethiopia for its nutritious rootstock and stem, not its (inedible) fruits.

12 m/40 ft

**BANANA***Musa acuminata*
F: Musaceae

The seedless hybrid of Asian wild ancestors, cultivated bananas grow sterile male flowers at the end of their fruiting branches.

9 m
30 ft2 m
6½ ft**INDIAN SHOT***Canna indica*
F: Cannaceae

This tropical American plant has unusual flowers in which some of the petals are fused with pollen-producing stamens. There are many cultivated varieties.



1.5 m/5 ft

each yellow bract
protects four or
five tiny flowers**CHINESE YELLOW BANANA***Musella lasiocarpa*
F: Musaceae

Possibly extinct in the wild, this mountain species from China produces a yellow flower spike that can last for months.

